

GDD – Elpis

Initial Date: 17/10/2021

Update Date: 27/06/2022

Title: BAU Senior Game Project

GDD Version: 6

Index

1. About the Game

- 1.1. Genre
- 1.2. Concept
- 1.3. Aesthetic Goals
- 1.4. Target Audience
 - a. Core
 - b. Sub

2. Story

- 2.1. Background Lore

3. Gameplay

- 3.1. Core Mechanics
 - a. Soul Manipulation
 - b. Combat (Basic)
 - c. Living Entities → Creatures
 - i. Simple Creature
 - ii. Smoke Creature
 - iii. Aggressive Creature
- 3.2. Sub Mechanics
- 3.3. Enemies / Obstacles
- 3.4. User Experience
- 3.5. Controls

4. Art Style

5. References / Moodboard & Sketches

6. Music and Cinematics

7. Development Details

- 7.1. Team
- 7.2. Software Details

8. Extras / Notes

1. ABOUT THE GAME

1.1. **Genre:** TPS, Exploration, Adventure, Puzzle, Story Based

1.2. **Concept:** Eventually the game will happen to be a puzzle solving game. The concept is offering the player a scythe as a companion which includes the two symbolic gods those one would represent death and the other would represent life.

With this concept our main character will be the balancing act as an ordinary human which eventually will have a forced partnership. The concept of scythe will represent an act of relic which would contain the two gods, hence the health granting and taking by the main character would be explained by this way. The theme and the level would be two representative environments as one will represent the good and the other would represent the evil.

Basically, the games' main theme would be to showcase the two faces of the medallion. With all things considered, the obvious character development is the important thing here to narrate the story.

1.3. **Aesthetic Goals:** Giving the feeling of exploration and the wondering character development as the main character becomes more contrast with his / her first version in the game. Getting influenced by the gods with the help of the scythe would give a more epic essence to the game.

Also, the art style would make a challenge to develop yet if it is executed properly, it might give some edge to the story telling and the aesthetic visuality gameplay wise with particle effects from the scythe.

The story will be delivered to the player within cinematics that will explain some of the events within the stylistic 2D line art, making them not a 3D cutscene, but a 2D comic book.

1.4. Target Audience:

- a) **Core:** Puzzle and adventure lovers, but mostly some mythology enthusiasts. Might even go up to PEGI 18.
- b) **Sub:** This might also attract some interest some of the soul / rogue like lovers as combat might give an edge to these people as mechanics.

2. STORY

2.1. Background Lore:

IN THIS UNIVERSE THAT 2 ALMIGHTY GODS CREATED, THERE WERE 2 DIFFERENT REALMS.
THE HUMAN REALM AND THE LIMBONARIUM.

THE 2 ALMIGHTY GODS, IURIE (GOD OF ORDER) AND ZAYANA (GOD OF DESTRUCTION)
CREATED GODLINGS TO BALANCE AND MAINTAIN THE POWERS OF HUMAN REALM.
AND THEY CREATED VESSELS TO HELP BALANCE LIFE FORCE IN EXISTENCE.

Our Main Character(MC) is a the last heir of EMPIRE OF YWARATH, the land of GODS of
CREATION and DESTRUCTION.

The first Emperor of Ywarath known to be the first prophet of the creation and destruction.

His noble bloodline kept the prophecy through hundreds of years.

However, one day their bloodline started suffering from Zayana's Curse, which result in with
decreased numbers of descendances in time. Most of them started dying in early ages and
surviving ones ended up infertility.

The last heir, MC, is the only young heir alive and retention of the prophecy can only be
protected by them. Unknowing if they are affected by Zayana's Curse or not, the MC sets out
on his/her lifepath to save the prophecy however they can.

However, the path cuts off early. As the marks of Zayana's Curse starts to appear on MC
when they reach the age that most of their cursed family members died. Faced with the
ultimate end, MC begins waiting out his/her days.

When the destined day comes, invisible to mortal eye, Xvenda descends from The
Limbonarium to claim MC's life, only to be stopped by Aavan. Interrupted in his mission, the
gods of Creation and Destruction clash. Realizing the equal strength between them, Xvenda
realizes a means of stronger power must be brought into the battle, and summons his Vessel,
(Scythe's Name). Eyes clouded with his mission and responsibilities, Xvenda strucks down
Aavan with the Vessel. The battle shakes the Bora around the realm, even blinking the gods
into the sight of the naked eye. However the amount of siphoning power required to absorb a
god worth of Bora into the Vessel proves too strong for Xvenda to resist, resulting in both
gods to be devoured by the (Scythe's Name).

Away from home, the MC witnesses this battle unfold as the gods come crushing down the
lands of the Humangard with all their divinity, before they are siphoned inside the divine
Vessel.

The MC shakes in fear and wants to leave, but knowing that he/she will die soon enough
anyways, they gather courage and approach the site of the battle to investigate. The Vessel
that Xvenda once wielded lies inside a crater filled with torn feathers impaling the ground.

The MC approaches and touches the Scythe... olaylar gelişir.....

3. GAMEPLAY

3.1. Core Mechanic/s:

- a) **Soul Manipulation:** The core mechanic is going to be the health points give and take system via the scythe that the main character obtains. Parallelized with the lore of two gods, the player would be able to solve puzzles and interact with combat zones. Some entities would be needed alive to solve some puzzles / levels.

If the player wants to take health points from an entity, they are going to have to hit it with the scythe as a melee weapon. To give it back a ranged style is enough. Players will have an additional health storage for stolen ones and the limit of that storage will not be available to exceed and if it does the player will not be able to steal an entity's health at all.

- b) **Combat (Basic):** Obviously the scythe will give the urge to fight with entities. At this stage this mechanic's aim was to defeat some of the entities and make them eligible for health manipulation. If it is a boss, each hit is going to drain its stance/stamina and if it isn't, one hit would be enough to take all the health.

The entities will have separate health points to live or die. When their health point is zero, then the player will be able to snatch their souls. With the healing action, all the health points and the souls will be granted back to the target entity. The player needs to slash the soul giving entities until their hit point is zero, then the player can steal the offered souls from the entity.

c) Living Entities → Creatures: There will be some living entities that are considered as AI, and they will have their own decision wills depending on the perception of sight and hearing.

- i. **Yeti:** This simple creature is there and roams around until the player spooks it with footsteps or a scythe swing sound. When it is spooked or scared, it will run until it is out of the player's step range. Simple stepping would spook it and make it run away in a casual speed. Swinging the scythe will make it run away in much faster speeds for a duration. It is a source for souls, so after enough amount of landed hits, the player can steal its souls.
- ii. **Evil Yeti:** The aggressive creature is already spawned in the world. It will roam until it sees the player. Once this creature sees the player, it will chase the player down and if the distance is enough, it will attempt to attack in a melee style. Once the player is out of its sight it will calm down and go back to the roaming phase. This creature will be available for soul manipulation and can be healed back if needed.
- iii. **Tar Creature:** The tar creature is not spawned into the world; however, the map will contain triggers around. Once the player hits one of these triggers, one of these smoke creatures will spawn, and then start a following action. This creature will not be available to gain or lose souls. There is still a pending decision on if this creature will be healable or not.
- iv. **Darih:** This creature will act like the boss of the first level and be the one beat to finish the first showcase of the game. Darih, has a skillset of throwing projectiles and attacking faster towards the player with different kind of animations.

3.2. Sub Mechanics/s:

- a) **Character Movement:** Basic TPS movement including basic jumping. Players can also use the cube to extend elevations while jumping. Camera movement will be discussed, along with the development of the main character.
- b) **Melee Style:** In this edition only a light attack, heavy attack and a blocking system would be sufficient against the bosses. After all, we do not want to create a hack and slash game and fade out the core mechanic below the combat system.
- c) **Character Sustainability:** Different from the soul storage the player has, the character has an unknown health that will be showcased with visual effect, such as blood effect on the screen.
- d) **Living Entities → Level Elements:** The game will feature level elements that will give purpose to the core mechanic. With the taken souls from the living creatures, the player can use those souls to activate and deactivate puzzle / adventure elements such as moving platforms, extending platforms and future designed level elements.
 - i. **Longroot:** This root can be slashed to take souls and can be healed to grow again to create bridges and platforms around the level for levitation. There will be sliding and bridging versions of it.
 - ii. **Tree:** These trees are going to be around as free soul sources for the player to slash.
 - iii. **Bird:** This bird is working with souls and must be alive to function. For a duration the player will be available to fly holding onto this bird.

3.3. Enemies/Obstacles:

- a) Simple Yeti and Tar entities will be around the map. Some of them will provide souls for the player to use and some of them will be there to create a difficulty for the player by chasing him / her.
- b) Also, there is a boss that is featured with a different set of skills, and greater values of HP and souls.

3.4. User Experience:

Simple entities that can be slashed without any stance or stagger, so they are going to be easy bites to manipulate health. Proper bosses that are also there for health manipulation however they will have stances (stamina) that can be drained in every scythe hit. After the stance is drained, it will start to refill back after a cooldown however during that time the boss will be available for health manipulation.

3.5. Controls

- a)** Right click creates a zoomed shoulder cam putting the character into healing mode. Left click works for healing in that mode. Otherwise left click works as a slashing button with the scythe. One click is enough to heal creatures for now.
- b)** On ground: WASD for movement and Space key for jumping.
- c)** Mouse movement for looking around and moving along with TPS mode.
- d)** E key to interact if there is an interactable object around
- e)** Flying: WASD for movement, Space key to gain altitude and Ctrl key to lose altitude.
- f)** V key for desaturation mode

4. ART STYLE

Some unique art style is required for this game. Particle effects might be important, as the scythe might need to create a dynamic art style during combat and puzzle solving.

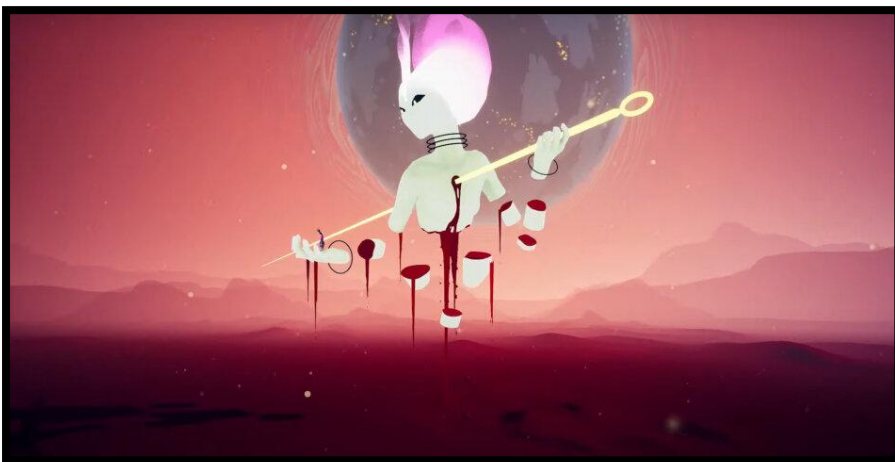
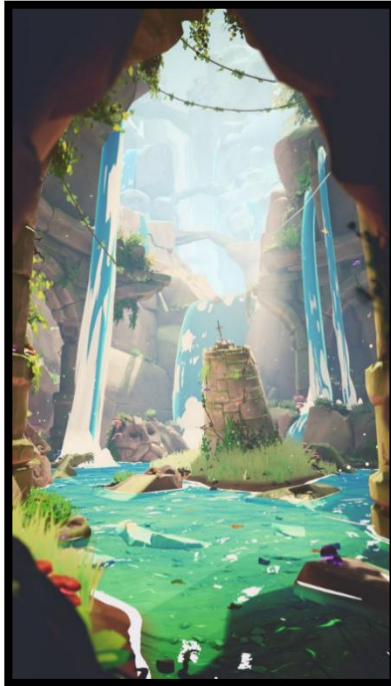
Post processing will play a key role. An art style like Zelda which indicates “sugar candy” graphics is the aim. The colour palette will be dark and light according to the level type. (Ex: Dark for hell and light for heaven.) References is there to give ideas and create a mood board on this.

Obviously, the environment features a lot of contrast colours with tress being red and the rest being cold green natural colours. The method of colouring will feature some of its emotional representations. Again, it was intended to create a ‘holy’ atmosphere

The following features our environment design from the in-game engine:



5. REFERENCES / MOODBOARD & SKETCHES



6. MUSIC AND CINEMATICS

Music has been discussed to be in a style that it will feature some holy and epic elements in it. It must be effective on telling a story on the war between two dominant Gods and the player must feel that.

With that said, the cutscenes will feature the story (lore) in a comic book style so the music will hold a big place on delivering the aesthetic goals to the player. Also, the sound design must combine with the narration fully.

For the gameplay soundtrack the, the game aims to feature peaceful sounds that would combine with the environmental sounds. The sound design is also important as the sounds like footsteps, scythe sounds, and water sounds would create a combination of a soothing gameplay feel until the player encounters a serious boss fight that will found in several locations of the level. From that point on a drum supported epic soundtrack might take place.

7. DEVELOPMENT DETAILS

7.1. Team:

- **Designer/s:**
 - **Game Designer:** İzel Levi, Bora Aydın
 - **Level Designer:** Bora Aydın
- **Programmer/s:**
 - **Gameplay Programmer:** İzel Levi, Bora Aydın
 - **Level Programmer:** Bora Aydın
- **Artist/s:**
 - **3D Artist:** Esin Yılmaz, Furkan Doğan
 - **2D Artist:** Esin Yılmaz, Furkan Doğan, Batuhan Koçak
 - **Animator:** Atakan Düzyol
 - **VFX:** Furkan Doğan
- **Sound Designer/s:**
 - **Music:** Atakan Düzyol
 - **Environmental Sounds:** Atakan Düzyol
 - **Narration:** ?
- **Writer/s:**
 - **Lore and Story:** Esin Yılmaz, Bora Aydın

7.2. Software Details:

- **Engine:** UE4 Version 4.27.1
- **Art:** Maya 2022, ZBrush
- **Sound:** Ableton 9, GarageBand
- **Writing:** Miro

8. **EXTRAS / NOTES**

** TBC - To Be Changed

*** TBA - To Be Announced